

Salman A. Khan

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Education

- **Ph.D. in Economics**, University of Illinois Chicago (2021) — GPA: 4.0/4.0; Dissertation on education and labor market policy
- **Master in Economics and Finance**, CEMFI, Madrid (2013) — Full scholarship; advanced training in econometrics and applied microeconomics
- **B.Sc. in Economics**, Lahore University of Management Sciences (2011) — *Summa cum laude*

Professional Summary

Applied microeconomist and research leader specializing in large-scale randomized evaluations of education, workforce, and public safety programs. Experienced in managing cross-sector partnerships, multi-million-dollar research portfolios, and translating rigorous evidence into actionable policy guidance. Track record of high-impact research cited in federal policy documents and featured in national media.

National Policy Impact & Media Coverage

- Tutoring research cited in the *Economic Report of the President* (2025) and featured in the U.S. *Bureau of Labor Statistics Monthly Labor Review*; findings influenced nationwide tutoring scale-up efforts post-pandemic
- *Saga Tech* demonstrates technology-enabled models can reduce costs and staffing burdens without compromising effectiveness, informing national debates on sustainable tutoring models
- Research highlighted in *Evidence-Based Policy*, *CommonWealth Beacon*, and *K-12 Dive*
- *Back to Our Future* youth re-engagement initiative work featured in outlets including *Chalkbeat* and WBEZ Chicago
- Contributions acknowledged in Jens Ludwig's 2025 book *Unforgiving Places*, reflecting role in advancing research at the Crime Lab

Professional Experience

Research Director, University of Chicago Crime & Education Labs 2021–present

- Provide scientific direction for portfolio of RCTs and quasi-experimental studies on tutoring, personalized learning, workforce development, and youth re-engagement
- Manage research staff, budgets, IRB compliance, pre-analysis plans, and dissemination via reports, briefs, and policy forums
- Lead collaborations with public agencies and community partners; serve as Co-PI on grants with funders such as Arnold Ventures, Overdeck Family Foundation, Griffin Catalyst
- Coordinate partnerships across education, workforce, and public safety agencies, including CPS, NYC DOE, IDHS, IDHS, and nonprofit organizations
- Directed Education Lab's multi-year technical assistance partnership with A Better Chicago grantees, delivering data analysis, SEL survey design, and sustainability planning (2021–2024)

Graduate Instructor & Research Assistant, University of Illinois Chicago 2016–2021

- Instructor of Record for Econometrics (3 semesters, 200+ students), emphasizing causal

inference and empirical applications

- Research Assistant to Profs. Benjamin Feigenberg & Darren Lubotsky, focusing on labor economics and immigration shocks
- Organized graduate seminars and research presentations to support development of early-career scholars

Data Analyst, University of Chicago Crime & Education Labs

Summer 2018

- Analyzed administrative and survey data for randomized controlled trials, developing outcome measures to ensure rigorous evaluation and inform policy-relevant findings
- Analyzed crime classification data to support research on public safety and contribute to evidence-based violence prevention strategies

International Research Consultant

2012–2015

- Co-Investigator with World Bank/IDEAS on South Asia regional competitiveness study analyzing unrealized economic gains from limited India-Pakistan trade
- Statistical expert for UN Women Pakistan costing study on child marriage, producing estimates to inform national policy
- Policy analyst with Santander Bank on European responses to global financial crisis
- Co-organized USAID Conference on Improving Education Quality with 250+ stakeholders; authored official conference report

Key Research Projects

Tutoring & Learning Recovery

- *Saga Tech* demonstrates technology-enabled models can reduce costs by 30% and staffing needs by 50% while maintaining tutoring effectiveness
- *Saga Literacy* RCT showing significant gains in NWEA MAP reading outcomes for early-grade literacy tutoring
- *Long-Term Tutoring Follow-Up* tracking academic and college outcomes from original Match study cohorts across multiple years

Workforce Development

- *Genesys Works* RCT providing critical experimental evidence on workforce pipeline models during high school—a hot policy area where evidence is needed
- *STEM at Phoenix Military Academy* technical assistance on new STEM and leadership course offerings in partnership with CPS and U.S. Army Research Office

Public Safety & Youth Re-engagement

- *Back to Our Future* technical assistance for \$18M youth re-engagement initiative analyzing referral pathways and early outcomes at the intersection of education and public safety

Selected Publications & Working Papers

- “Can Technology Facilitate Scale? Evidence from a Randomized Evaluation of High-Dosage Tutoring” (NBER Working Paper; under review; cited in Economic Report of the President 2025)
- “Can High-Dosage Literacy Tutoring Put First-Graders on the Road to Success? Evidence from an RCT” (Working paper in preparation)
- “The Reliability of Replications: A Study in Computational Reproductions,” *Royal Society Open Science*, 2022
- “Unmet Expectations: Impacts of School Construction on Female Outcomes in Rural Punjab, Pakistan” (Best Student Paper, Australian Gender Economics Workshop)
- “The Great Recession and the Human Capital Investments of Youth” (Working paper)

Policy Reports & Technical Publications

- *Back to Our Future: Policy Brief & Year 1 Technical Report* (2023), UChicago Crime & Education Labs — Lead Author
- *Phoenix Military Academy STEM Technical Report* (2023), UChicago Education Lab — Co-author
- *Costing Study on Child Marriage in Pakistan* (2020), UN Women/NCSW — Co-author
- *USAID Conference Report on Improving Education Quality* (2014), LUMS — Lead Author

Selected Honors & Recognition

- Best Student Paper Award, Australian Gender Economics Workshop (2021)
- Houston H. Stokes Award for Academic Excellence, UIC (2016)
- CEMFI Fellowship (2011–2013)
- Fulbright Scholar, University of Massachusetts Amherst (2010)
- Fulbright Mentor, University of Massachusetts Amherst (2014)
- Dean’s Honor List, LUMS (2007–2011)

Professional Affiliations

American Economic Association (AEA) — Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) — Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)